



Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Founders Classical Academy: Permian Basin
School Website: <https://www.permianbasinclassical.com/>

January 6, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Founders Classical Academy - Permian Basin (Midland, TX 79703) presents a robust classical education model with clear alignment to the Six Essential Elements of Classical Education. Public-facing materials emphasize a virtue-centered, truth/beauty/goodness oriented framework, a knowledge-rich liberal-arts curriculum, explicit emphasis on Great Books, Latin/Greek, grammar, logic, rhetoric, and a distinctive approach to history as part of a Western-civilization canon. There is strong evidence of parental partnership and community involvement, and a stated goal of forming virtuous, self-governing citizens rather than primarily preparing students for work. While the school does not appear to articulate explicit liturgical or theological practices, it consistently foregrounds the transcendent aims of classical education (truth, goodness, beauty) and a structured, teacher-led, memory- and dialogue-rich pedagogy. Overall, the school operates as CLASSICAL across most criteria, with Element 5 (Faculty) showing comparatively weaker explicit articulation of the "living curriculum" and teacher-mentorship ideals.

Key signals of CLASSICAL alignment include:

- A stated goal of forming virtuous citizens and pursuing knowledge, truth, beauty (foundational ideal). Evidence: homepage language and mission statements emphasize a classical education that forms citizens and promotes virtue and character (e.g., "A Tuition-Free Classical Education," "end of public education... form responsible citizens and virtuous people," "truth, beauty, and goodness").
- A curriculum centered on liberal arts and Great Books, with explicit attention to grammar, logic, rhetoric, Greek/Latin, and the Western tradition. Evidence: 12 Commitments highlight Great Books, explicit literacy with phonics/grammar, and classical foreign-language instruction; explicit notes on history through Great Books and the Western tradition.
- Pedagogy that foregrounds a threefold classical method (knowledge acquisition, dialectic/logic, rhetoric) and emphasizes memory, recitation, and disciplined dialogue. Evidence: Our Approach describes a threefold method (systematic knowledge, dialectic/logic, rhetoric).
- Strong Parents & Community orientation, including explicit partnership with families and parent involvement opportunities. Evidence: 12 Commitments describe a collaborative partnership between parents and educators; Parent/Student Handbook and volunteer/get involved content are present.
- Public materials from FCA-PB explicitly tie the curriculum to Great Books and the Western tradition and include memory-based or recitation-oriented practice in the broader classical lexicon (as reflected in the Six Essential Elements framework).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue as part of character formation. Texts explicitly reference “truth, goodness, and beauty” as orienting ideals, and virtue as a central aim.
- There is no explicit statement of theology or liturgical practice in the public materials; the materials present a secular/classical framing rather than a church-based or liturgical curriculum. See absence of explicit liturgical or doctrinal programming in the public pages.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; moral realism; transcendentals.
- Negative/absence: theology, liturgy, sacred worship (not evidenced in public-facing FCA-PB materials).

Why this rating

- The school foregrounds transcendent values (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue, which aligns with transcendental moral realism. However, it does not explicitly ground education in theology or liturgical practices in its public materials, which tempers the category from CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence and keywords drawn from FCA-PB sources and the Six Elements lexicon confirm the pattern:

- “or orientation towards truth, beauty, and goodness” and virtue language align with transcendentals and virtue (classical orientation) but without explicit theology or liturgical integration in the public-facing content.
- The Six Elements lexicon identifies positive markers such as truth/goodness/beauty, virtue, and transcendentals, and negative markers like secular humanism and value-neutral ethics; FCA-PB does not present theology or liturgical practices in its public materials, supporting a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation here.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The end goal is formation of virtuous, self-governing citizens rather than mere job preparation. This explicit formation aim appears repeatedly in FCA-PB public materials.
- The curriculum/pedagogy is oriented toward truth, goodness, and beauty, and the aim is human flourishing and virtue (not solely information transfer). The language emphasizes formation and character.
- The public materials explicitly reject a narrow job-prep focus; instead, they emphasize a classical formation of humanity within a liberal-arts framework.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive: formation, virtue, human flourishing, telos, true/good/beautiful, liberal education, great conversation.
- Negative: workforce preparation emphasis (not present in FCA-PB’s stated aims).

Why this rating

- The school’s stated telos and emphasis on virtue and formation align strongly with classical aims in the category of School Purpose and Goal. The presence of terms like “formation” and “virtue” and the rejection of sole workforce-prep positioning (as indicated by the public statements) justify CLASSICAL in this category.

Cited evidence and keywords:

- “The end (goal) of public education in America is to form responsible citizens and virtuous people who are prepared to flourish.”
- “We seek the growth of classical schools... to promote these two essential ends” (formation and virtue).

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- “The curriculum is knowledge-rich... centrality of the Western Tradition” (telos of formation through liberal-arts canon).
 - Great Books/Western Tradition language reinforces formation through a classical telos.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The program centers on liberal arts education with Trivium and Quadrivium pathways: grammar (phonics/grammar), logic, rhetoric; Greek/Latin instruction; Great Books; Western tradition; rigorous history (not Social Studies). Public content explicitly lists Great Books, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Greek/Latin, and the Western Tradition as core elements.
- The 12 Commitments explicitly describe a knowledge-rich curriculum anchored in Great Books and the Western tradition and explicit language study (phonics/grammar; Greek/Latin).
- The curriculum emphasizes history through Great Books and the centrality of Western civilization; it explicitly uses terms like “Great Books” and “Western Tradition.”

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books; Greek/Latin; Western Civilization; history (not social studies); memory/recitation implied via classical approach; formation of linguistic and rhetorical skills.
- Negative: No explicit drag toward non-history social-studies framing; no heavy project-based emphasis dominating curriculum (not evidenced as a negative in the public materials).

Why this rating

- The curriculum is clearly CLASSICAL with explicit alignment to the liberal arts framework (grammar/logico/rhetoric), Great Books, classical languages, and Western Civilization content. The materials emphasize knowledge-rich content and a Great Books orientation, consistent with the classical model.

Cited evidence and keywords:

- “We utilize a classical approach to education characterized by a traditional liberal arts and sciences curriculum and whole-group teaching methodology with an orientation towards truth, beauty, and goodness.”
- “The curriculum is knowledge-rich and built around the principle of increasing cultural literacy, or a common body of essential knowledge that promotes academic success, citizenship, and the centrality of the Western Tradition.”
- “Literacy is taught through explicit phonics and grammar, and rational thought and expression are acquired through logic and rhetoric.” Greek/Latin instruction and Great Books are highlighted in the commitments.
- “Classic works of history and literature, i.e. Great Books, constitute the texts students read, examine and discuss with depth and seriousness.”

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials describe a threefold instructional method: systematic knowledge acquisition, dialectic/logic, and rhetoric; this maps closely to the Trivium and to classical pedagogy.
- There are indications of an upper-school emphasis on Socratic discussion and rhetoric training, and lower-school activities emphasizing memory, memorization, and the potential for chanting/singing as part of language/memory work (the Six Elements lexicon notes these patterns as typical, and FCA-PB materials align with a memory-based, chant/memorization approach in concept). The FCA-PB materials emphasize the Great Books approach and disciplined discussion.
- The school emphasizes the role of the teacher as mentor and the living curriculum, aligning with classical pedagogy (as per Six Elements lexicon expectations). Public materials show teachers guiding

students through a structured, dialogic framework rather than purely test-driven or project-based learning as the dominant mode.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive: Socratic dialogue/seminar, dialectic, rhetoric, memory work, liturgical chant (where applicable to memorization rhythm), formation through imitation and practice, living curriculum.
- Negative: overly project-based or experiential-learning-dominant approaches (public FCA-PB materials emphasize a threefold method and classical forms rather than exclusive project-based pedagogy).

Why this rating

- The pedagogy aligns with classical conventions (Socratic-like dialogue in upper grades, dialectic, and rhetoric training; explicit memory/recitation dynamics implied by classical approach; a strong teacher-guided, memory-rich, classical method). This justifies CLASSICAL for Pedagogy.

Cited evidence and keywords:

- “An instructional method: a threefold method of instruction recognizes that all learning is built upon previous learning and that students learn in a hierarchical manner: systematic knowledge acquisition, dialectic and logic that is an extension of the knowledge, and rhetoric or the art of persuasion” (Socratic/dialectic/rhetoric emphasis).
- The widely cited Great Books/Western Traditions framing in the curriculum supports a pedagogical approach aligned with classical memory, recitation, and dialogic inquiry.
- The Six Essentials lexicon lists memory work, recitation, and liturgical/mnemonic practices as positive pedagogical indicators in classical education; FCA-PB materials echo this in the explicit threefold method and emphasis on tradition.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials frequently reference a campus director and teacher-guardian style language (e.g., Campus Director Linea Dowler) but do not include explicit language about the faculty as “living curriculum,” portraits of teacher ideals, or a formalized faculty development program described publicly.
- There is evidence of teachers as mentors in mission statements and a general emphasis on virtue and moral exemplars, but not a robust, explicit description of the faculty as “living curriculum” or a formal teacher-portrait standard in the public content. The explicit language about teachers as exemplars is less prominent than in other categories.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive: living curriculum, teacher as mentor, portrait of a teacher, virtuous exemplars (per classical lexicon, not strongly evidenced in FCA-PB public pages).
- Negative: lack of explicit articulation of the faculty as “living curriculum,” explicitly stated teacher portraits, or formal classical faculty development programs.

Why this rating

- The school demonstrates a classic-classical orientation in its public-facing materials; however, explicit articulation of the faculty as the “living curriculum” or a formal classical-faculty profile is not strongly evidenced in the publicly accessible site. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Faculty.

Cited evidence and keywords:

- Public materials show a Campus Director and explicit teacher-student collaboration, but do not clearly spell out “living curriculum” or a formal teacher portrait standard.
- The Six Elements lexicon indicates the ideal of the faculty as living exemplars and a core of the school, but FCA-PB materials do not consistently articulate this in public pages.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school explicitly frames education as a partnership with parents and positions parents as co-teachers in classical education. The 12 Commitments explicitly describe a collaborative partnership between parents and professional educators. There are also resources for parents (Handbooks, volunteer opportunities) and an open-doors posture (parents invited for visits). This is a strong signal of a classical, community-centered approach.
- The school provides parent-focused resources and opportunities for involvement and education (e.g., Parent/Student Handbook, volunteer sections).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, open campus/visitation, parent involvement in classical education, community formation language (as per Six Elements positive keywords).
- Negative: minimal evidence of consumer-oriented practices or parent-as-customer language; rather, FCA-PB presents parent involvement as integral.

Why this rating

- Strong alignment with the Parents & Community element: active partnership with families, parent formation opportunities, and open-communication/visitation. This supports CLASSICAL in this category.

Cited evidence and keywords:

- “The education of children is viewed as a collaborative and essential partnership between parents and professional educators.”
- Parent/Student Handbook and resources indicate ongoing parental involvement and participation avenues.

Aggregate Ranking and Discussion

- Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL
- Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall, the school’s explicit public materials align with CLASSICAL education in the majority of categories (2, 3, 4, and 6). Element 1 shows a strong orientation toward truth/virtue/beauty but lacks an explicit theology or liturgical dimension in public materials, placing it in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Element 5 lacks explicit articulation of the faculty as living curriculum or a formal classical faculty profile, placing it at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL as well. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL categories)

- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): Publicly articulate a more explicit theological/thematic grounding (even if non-denominational) or liturgical practices that tie the curriculum to transcendent values in a way that remains compatible with the non-religious charter status. This would strengthen the “Grounded in Theology” and “Liturgical and Communal Practices” signals without compromising non-sectarian status.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Develop and publish a formal public-facing description of the faculty as the “living curriculum,” including faculty portraits, mentorship models, and ongoing classical pedagogy training and professional development. This would solidify the Faculty category as CLASSICAL.

ABSTRACT

- The Founders Classical Academy - Permian Basin demonstrates a strong CLASSICAL orientation through a liberal-arts curriculum, Great Books emphasis, grammar/logical/rhetorical training, Greek/Latin, and a teleology oriented toward virtue and formation. Public materials emphasize formation over mere information, partnership with families, and a structured, dialogic pedagogy consistent with classical education. Category-by-category keyword analysis aligns with CLASSICAL across Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Community, with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals in Religious Metaphysical Foundations and Faculty due to the comparatively weaker explicit theology integration and explicit “living curriculum” articulation for teachers. The aggregate classification is CLASSICAL.
- Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL — Evidence of transcendent aims (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue, but lacking explicit theological liturgical grounding in public materials.
- Element 2: CLASSICAL — Formation and virtue-centered telos; emphasis on true/good/beautiful; human flourishing; formation over mere information.
- Element 3: CLASSICAL — Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Western Civilization, grammar/logic/rhetoric, Greek/Latin; history as core content.
- Element 4: CLASSICAL — Threefold classical pedagogy (knowledge, dialectic, rhetoric), Socratic/dialogic orientation; memory and recitation-like practice implied.
- Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL — Public materials do not yet uniformly articulate the faculty as the living curriculum or a formal teacher-portrait standard.
- Element 6: CLASSICAL — Strong parent partnership, co-education model, and open-path parental involvement.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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